

Friends and comrades throughout the United States and throughout the world,

have an overdeveloped economy which is so infused with the need for profit

labors in the life, liberty and happiness of the children and grandchildren

liberty and the pursuit of happiness has in its maturity become an im-

THE BLACK PANTHER

Black Community News Service

VOL. V NO. 11

SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 12, 1970

PUBLISHED
WEEKLY

THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

MINISTRY OF INFORMATION
BOX 2967, CUSTOM HOUSE
SAN FRANCISCO, CA 94126

25
cents

this would pass, we recognize however, that it has now passed and we are a people who enjoy no equal protection of the law, and our future action must be guided by our sufferance, and not by our prudence.

Two centuries ago when the United States was a new nation, conceived in liberty and dedicated to life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness, the conditions which prevailed in the nation, and the assumptions upon which its foundations were built, were such that they ensured the United States would come to its maturity under circumstances which mean that for a substantial proportion of its citizens' life is nothing more than a prison of poverty, and the only happiness we enjoy is the laughing to keep from crying.

The United States of America was born at a time when the nation covered relatively little land, a narrow strip of political divisions on the Eastern seaboard. The United States of America was born at a time when the population was small and fairly homogeneous both racially and culturally. Thus the people called Americans were a different people in a different place. Furthermore, they had a different economic system. The small population and the fertile land available meant that with the agricultural emphasis of the economy, people were able to advance according to their motivation and ability. It was an agricultural economy and with the circumstances surrounding it, Democratic Capitalism flourished in the new nation.

The following years were to see this new nation rapidly develop into a multi-limbed giant. The new nation acquired land and spread from a narrow strip on the Eastern seaboard to cover the entire continent with but few exceptions. The new nation acquired a population to fill this newly acquired land. This population was drawn from the continents of Africa, Asia, Europe and America. Thus a nation conceived of a homogeneous people of a small area and in a small area grew into a heterogeneous people, a large number, and spread over an entire continent. This is a fundamental characteristic of the nation and its people substance and the nature of America. Furthermore, the social changes were marked by economic changes. A rural and agricultural economy became an urban and industrialized economy, as farming was replaced by manufacturing. The Democratic Capitalism of our early days became caught up in a relentless drive to obtain profits until the selfish motivation for profit eclipsed the unselfish principles of democracy. Thus 200 years later we

see this when we note the basic contradictions found in the history of this nation. The government, its social conditions, and the legal documents which brought freedom from oppression, which brought human dignity and human rights to the people of this nation had entirely opposite consequences from another portion of the people. While the majority group achieved freedom, the minorities achieved alienation from the lands of their fathers and slavery. The evidence for this is clear and undeniable.

We find evidence for majority freedom and minority oppression in the fact that the expansion of the United States government and the acquisition of lands was at the unjust expense of the American Indians, the original possessors of the land and still its immediate heirs. The long march of the Cherokees on the "Trail of Tears" and the actual disappearance of other Indian nations testify to the unwillingness and inability of the government and this government's constitution to incorporate racial differences.

We find evidence for majority freedom and minority oppression in the fact that even while the early years were proclaiming their freedom, they were deliberately and systematically depriving Africans of their freedom. These basic contradictions have only been exacerbated (made worse) which implicate the government and

the people. The government and the people have furthered the contradictions. Our forebears, through constitutional and Civil Rights laws have made no change in our condition. We are still a people without equal protection and due process of law. We recognize then that the oppressive acts of the United States government when contrasted with the testaments of freedom, carries forward a basic contradiction found in all the legal documents upon which this government is based.

Generation after generation of the majority group have been born, they have worked, and they have seen the fruits of their labors in the life, liberty and happiness of their children and grandchildren. Generation after generation of Black people in America have been born, they have worked, and they have seen the fruits of their

to complete the promise of an 18th Century Revolution in the framework of a 20th Century government, economic society was doomed to failure. The descendants of that small company of original settlers of this land are not among the ruling class of today, they have become a small ruling class in control of worldwide economic system. The Constitution set up by their ancestors serves the people, for the people have changed. The people of the 18th Century have become the ruling class of the 20th Century. The people of the 20th Century are the descendants of the slaves and dispossessed of the 18th Century. The Constitution set up to serve the people of the 18th Century serves the ruling class of the 20th Century, and the people of today stand waiting for a foundation of their own liberty and pursuit of happiness. The Civil Rights Movement has not laid this foundation, and it cannot lay this foundation because of the structure of the United States society and its Constitution. The Civil Rights Movement has not achieved its goals. They have only made programs. They have not achieved compensation, they have not achieved a new form of government, they have not achieved a new society, they have not achieved a new way of life.

to complete the promise of an 18th Century Revolution in the framework of a 20th Century government, economic society was doomed to failure. The descendants of that small company of original settlers of this land are not among the ruling class of today, they have become a small ruling class in control of worldwide economic system. The Constitution set up by their ancestors serves the people, for the people have changed. The people of the 18th Century have become the ruling class of the 20th Century. The people of the 20th Century are the descendants of the slaves and dispossessed of the 18th Century. The Constitution set up to serve the people of the 18th Century serves the ruling class of the 20th Century, and the people of today stand waiting for a foundation of their own liberty and pursuit of happiness. The Civil Rights Movement has not laid this foundation, and it cannot lay this foundation because of the structure of the United States society and its Constitution. The Civil Rights Movement has not achieved its goals. They have only made programs. They have not achieved compensation, they have not achieved a new form of government, they have not achieved a new society, they have not achieved a new way of life.

to complete the promise of an 18th Century Revolution in the framework of a 20th Century government, economic society was doomed to failure. The descendants of that small company of original settlers of this land are not among the ruling class of today, they have become a small ruling class in control of worldwide economic system. The Constitution set up by their ancestors serves the people, for the people have changed. The people of the 18th Century have become the ruling class of the 20th Century. The people of the 20th Century are the descendants of the slaves and dispossessed of the 18th Century. The Constitution set up to serve the people of the 18th Century serves the ruling class of the 20th Century, and the people of today stand waiting for a foundation of their own liberty and pursuit of happiness. The Civil Rights Movement has not laid this foundation, and it cannot lay this foundation because of the structure of the United States society and its Constitution. The Civil Rights Movement has not achieved its goals. They have only made programs. They have not achieved compensation, they have not achieved a new form of government, they have not achieved a new society, they have not achieved a new way of life.

We gather here to let it be known at home and abroad that a nation conceived in liberty and dedicated to life,

MUNITY. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR DECENT HOUSING FOR ALL OUR PEOPLE. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR A TRUE EDUCATION OF OUR PEOPLE. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR EXEMPTION FROM MILITARY SERVICE. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR AN END TO POLICE BRUTALITY. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR FREEDOM FOR ALL POLITICAL PRISONERS. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR FAIR TRIALS FOR ALL MEN BY A JURY OF THEIR PEERS. THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY CALLS FOR A UNITED NATIONS PLEBISCITE TO DETERMINE THE WILL OF BLACK PEOPLE AS TO THEIR NATIONAL DESTINY.

Black people and oppressed people in general have lost faith in the leaders of America, in the government of America, and in the very structure of American government—that is the Constitution, its legal foundation. This loss of faith is based upon the overwhelming evidence that this government will not live according to that Constitution because the Constitution is not designed for its people. For this reason we assemble a Constitutional Convention to consider rational and positive alternatives. Alternatives which will place their emphasis on the common man. Alternatives which will bring about a new economic system in which the rewards as well as the work will be equally shared by all people—a Socialist framework. Alternatives which will guarantee that within the Socialist framework all groups will be adequately represented in the decision-making and administration which affects their lives. Alternatives which will guarantee that all men will attain their full manhood rights, that they will be able to live, be free, and seek out their goals which give them respect and dignity while permitting the same privileges for every other man regardless of his condition or status.

The sacredness of man and of the human spirit requires that human dignity and integrity ought to be always respected by every other man. We will seek for nothing less, for at this point in history anything less is but a living death. WE WILL BE FREE and we are here to ordain a new Constitution which will ensure our freedom by enshrining (cherishing) the dignity of the human spirit.

ALL POWER TO THE PEOPLE

THE PEOPLE AND THE PEOPLE ALONE WERE THE MOTIVE
FORCE IN THE MAKING OF HISTORY OF THE REVOLUTIONARY
PEOPLE'S CONSTITUTIONAL CONVENTION PLENARY SESSION!

INSIDE:

FIVE YEAR OLD BLACK CHILD ATTACKED BY MANIAC
THE TOMBS, N. Y.

HARVEY NOBLES MURDERED BY PIGS, BROOKLYN, N.Y.

REVOLUTIONARY PEOPLE'S CONSTITUTIONAL CONVENTION